

Cyanide Discharges, Releases & Industrial Pretreatment Program Violations — Cadillac, Michigan

Investigative research report | Review window: January – July 2026 (with historical background) | Prepared: July 18, 2026 **Method:** 98-agent research sweep across 5 source angles; 16 sources fetched in full; 78 claims extracted; top 25 claims put through 3-vote adversarial verification (22 confirmed, 3 refuted, 0 unverified). Primary-source records (EPA ECHO DMR downloads, EPA Superfund profiles, federal court opinions, city records) were independently re-downloaded and reproduced by verifiers on 07/18/2026.

1. Executive Summary

Yes — primary federal records show a verified cyanide exceedance in Cadillac within the past six months.

Strongest verified finding (HIGH confidence, primary source, independently reproduced): The City of Cadillac Wastewater Treatment Plant (NPDES permit **MI0020257**, Outfall 001 to the Clam River) reported effluent **cyanide of 125 µg/L monthly average and 140 µg/L daily maximum** for the monitoring period ending **April 30, 2026** (DMR received by EPA May 19, 2026). That is approximately **21× the enforceable monthly-average limit of 5.9 µg/L** and, on a loading basis, **2.926 lb/day versus a 0.16 lb/day limit (~18×)**. Baseline effluent cyanide was 2.0–3.0 µg/L from January 2024 onward; it returned to 2.3 µg/L by May 2026 — a discrete spike, not a chronic condition.

Equally notable: as of the July 18, 2026 data pull, EPA's ECHO/ICIS system shows **no violation code, no exceedance percentage, and "No Violation Identified"** on all four April 2026 cyanide rows, and no formal enforcement action. Two **informal state Notices of Violation** appear in ECHO dated **May 22, 2026** and **June 10, 2026** — shortly after the DMR arrived — but ECHO does not attribute them to a pollutant. The missing violation flag most plausibly reflects ICIS's quarterly noncompliance-processing lag rather than a substantive determination (inference, flagged as such).

Source unknown: No public record identifies which industrial user, sewer segment, or process caused the April 2026 spike. The spike coincides with the **April 18–19, 2026 historic flood** that disabled a Cadillac sanitary-sewer lift station and led to ~16 million gallons of partially treated sewage reaching the Clam River — but that temporal coincidence is an **inference only**; no record links the flood to the cyanide result. The July 2026 EGLE violation notice to the city concerns the flood spill's **unmet 24-hour reporting requirement**, not cyanide.

Pattern context (MEDIUM confidence, secondary source reporting an official city notice): Cadillac's own annual significant-noncompliance notice, as reported by Cadillac News in February 2024, stated that factories in Cadillac discharged **more cyanide, zinc, copper, silver, cadmium and molybdenum into the city sewer than permitted in 2023**, with **five of seven named factories in exceedance all four quarters**. City officials said the WWTP intercepted the pollutants with no pass-through events.

Historical background (HIGH confidence, federal court records): Cyanide plating wastes are extensively documented at the abandoned **Northernair Plating** Superfund site in the Cadillac Industrial Park (drums of cyanide waste found on abandonment in 1981; a private sewer that "routinely leaked" plating wastewater; MDEQ later found elevated cyanide in soils along the sewer lines). Current EPA/EGLE monitoring of the industrial park targets VOCs, hexavalent chromium, and PFAS — **not cyanide**.

No evidence of exposure: No verified record documents cyanide detection in surface water, groundwater, soil, or any workplace in Jan–Jul 2026, and no OSHA/MIOSHA action surfaced. The exceedance is documented only at the WWTP effluent. A discharge pathway to the Clam River exists by definition (Outfall 001 discharges there), but no receiving-water cyanide measurement is on record, so environmental exposure is **not established**.

2. Chronological Timeline

Date	Event	Evidence class
1971	Northernair Plating builds a private sewer carrying plating wastes; a federal court later finds it "was designed to allow exfiltration of contaminant-laden wastewater into the ground" and leaked at loosely sealed joints	Verified (court record)
1981	Northernair abandons its Cadillac site; regulators find drums of cyanide-contaminated wastes, ~2,000 gal plating sludge, ~2,500 gal liquid plating solution	Verified (court/EPA + news history)

Date	Event	Evidence class
1983	Northernaire listed on the Superfund NPL; MDEQ later documents elevated cyanide, chromium, cadmium, lead, nickel, copper, zinc in soil along sewer lines	Verified (court record)
Aug 1996	LDFA-financed groundwater treatment plant becomes operational (carbon adsorption for hexavalent chromium; air stripping for VOCs); discharges to Clam River under NPDES limits	Verified (EPA Five-Year Review)
CY 2023	City's annual significant-noncompliance notice: multiple Cadillac factories exceed IPP permit limits for cyanide, zinc, copper, silver, cadmium, molybdenum; 5 of 7 named factories in exceedance all 4 quarters; city reports no pass-through	Agency finding via secondary source
Jan 2024 – Mar 2026	Cadillac WWTP effluent cyanide baseline 2.0–3.0 µg/L monthly average	Verified (ECHO DMR)
Dec 2025	Effluent cyanide 5.8 µg/L MO AVG — just under the 5.9 µg/L limit	Verified (ECHO DMR)
Fall 2025 (planned)	EPA + Cadillac LDFA begin sampling Northernaire monitoring wells for VOCs, hexavalent chromium, PFAS — cyanide not among analytes	Verified (EPA profile)
Apr 18–19, 2026	Historic flood disables transformer/pumps at a Cadillac sanitary-sewer lift	Verified (news, multiple)

Date	Event	Evidence class
	station; raw sewage flow to WWTP halted	
Apr 16–29, 2026	~16 million gallons of partially treated (disinfected, bypassing tertiary) sewage discharged to Clam River (~962,000 gal/day)	Verified (news citing city/EGLE)
Apr 2026 (monitoring period)	WWTP effluent cyanide 125 µg/L MO AVG / 140 µg/L daily max; 2.926 lb/d vs 0.16 lb/d limit	Verified (ECHO DMR, reproduced)
Apr 20, 2026	City Council meets one day after flood; minutes contain zero mention of cyanide, IPP, or enforcement (PFAS grant and flood damage discussed)	Verified (city minutes PDF)
May 19, 2026	April DMR received by EPA	Verified (ECHO)
May 22, 2026	Informal state NOV in ECHO (MI-65728194750515318); pollutant unattributed	Verified (ECHO)
May 2026 (monitoring period)	Effluent cyanide back to 2.3 µg/L MO AVG / 3.0 µg/L daily max	Verified (ECHO DMR)
Jun 10, 2026	Second informal state NOV in ECHO (MI-13706853456066754); pollutant unattributed	Verified (ECHO)
Jul 14, 2026	EGLE violation notice to City of Cadillac reported publicly — for failure to report the April spill within 24 hours ("related to unmet reporting requirements" — EGLE spokesperson Josef Stephens); EGLE found no	Verified (news quoting EGLE)

Date	Event	Evidence class
	detectable impact to the Clam River; city response due end of July 2026	
Jul 18, 2026	ECHO data pull: April cyanide rows still show "No Violation Identified"; no formal enforcement; June DMR not yet posted	Verified (ECHO, reproduced)

3. Facilities, Results, Limits, Violations & Agency Actions

Facility / Org	Location & sample point	Cyanide result (method/type)	Applicable limit	Violation status	Agency action	Current status
City of Cadillac WWTP (NPDES MI0020257)	Outfall 001, Effluent Gross, to Clam River	125 µg/L MO AVG / 140 µg/L daily max; 2.926 / 3.167 lb/d — Apr 2026 DMR (param 01257, monthly self-monitoring)	5.9 µg/L MO AVG (Enforcement type); 0.16 lb/d MO AVG; daily max monitor-only (limit period 01/01/2024 – 10/01/2027)	Exceedance evident on face of DMR; ECHO shows "No Violation Identified" (likely RNC processing lag — inference)	2 informal state NOVs (05/22 & 06/10/2026), pollutant unattributed; no formal action	Values back to baseline (2.3 µg/L) May 2026; June DMR pending
City of Cadillac WWTP	Clam River (receiving water), Apr 16–29, 2026	No cyanide measurement on record	—	EGLE NOV for failure to report ~16M gal partially treated sewage	EGLE violation notice (reported Jul 14, 2026); city response	Open — reporting violation only; EGLE: no detectable river impact

Facility / Org	Location & sample point	Cyanide result (method/type)	Applicable limit	Violation status	Agency action	Current status
				spill within 24 hrs	due end of Jul 2026	(cyanide not addressed)
Unnamed Cadillac factories (7) — IPP industrial users	City sewer system (industrial discharge points)	Exceeded IPP permit limits for cyanide + Zn, Cu, Ag, Cd, Mo in 2023; values not public	Facility-specific IPP permit limits (not public)	City-declared significant noncompliance (annual notice per 40 CFR 403.8(f)(2)(viii))	Public SNC notice; city reported no pass-through, no known watershed impact	Facility names, values, follow-up unknown — FOIA needed
Northernair Plating (Superfund, NPL 1983)	1002 6th St, Cadillac Industrial Park; soil, groundwater, private sewer	Historical: drums of cyanide waste (1981); elevated cyanide in soil (MDEQ); no quantitative values in surviving records	CERCLA cleanup standards	Historical CERCLA liability (litigated: Kelley v. Kysor; US v. Meyer; US v. Northernair)	Removal actions 1980s; LDFA-funded groundwater treatment since 1996	Current monitoring targets Cr(VI)/VOCs/PFAS — cyanide not sampled
Kysor Industrial Corp (Superfund)	Cadillac Industrial Park; groundwater	None — six commingled VOC plumes; zero cyanide mentions	—	—	Ongoing Superfund remediation	No cyanide association

Facility / Org	Location & sample point	Cyanide result (method/type)	Applicable limit	Violation status	Agency action	Current status
Cadillac LDFA	Groundwater treatment plant; extraction wells; discharge to Clam River	None on record	NPDES limits (plant discharge)	None found	None found	No record ties LDFA pumps/lift stations/pipelines to any cyanide release

4. Findings by Record System

4.1 MiEnviro Portal / EGLE

- **EGLE violation notice (July 2026):** concerns the unreported April flood sewage discharge — a **reporting** failure, not a cyanide or treatment violation. EGLE PIO Josef Stephens: violations "are related to unmet reporting requirements." City must respond by end of July 2026. EGLE's post-spill assessment found "no detectable impact to Clam River" — but nothing indicates cyanide was among the analytes checked (verified news quoting EGLE; the notice text itself is not public — FOIA target).
- **EGLE IPP program page:** background only; establishes EGLE Water Resources Division administers Michigan's IPP with the City of Cadillac as local control authority. Zero hits for "Cadillac" or "cyanide" (verified 3–0).
- **EGLE Cadillac Industrial Park Area of Interest page:** documents PFAS (max 7.24 ppt PFOA; 11 ppt PFBS, 2021–22 — below criteria) and historical hexavalent chromium. **No cyanide** (verified 3–0).
- **MiEnviro Portal:** the portal itself is a JavaScript application that could not be queried by automated fetch (confirmed 404/JS-only on direct access). Any Cadillac WWTP or IPP compliance documents filed there remain **unexamined** — a key access limitation and FOIA target.

4.2 EPA (ECHO / ICIS-NPDES / Superfund)

- **The core verified finding** (Section 1): April 2026 effluent cyanide at 21× the concentration limit and ~18× the loading limit, from the official DMR CSV downloaded directly from ECHO (echodata.epa.gov effluent-chart download for MI0020257),

reproduced value-for-value by an independent verifier on 07/18/2026. Quote from the record: `monitoring_period_end_date=04/30/2026 ...`

`dmr_value_nmbr=125 ... limit_value_nmbr=5.9`

`limit_unit_desc=ug/L ... value_received_date=05/19/2026`, with MO AVG rows carrying `dmr_limit_type_code_desc=Enforcement`.

- **No federal violation flag:** all four April cyanide rows (dmr_event_id 3628288631) show empty violation_code and `violation_severity=No Violation Identified`; the Detailed Facility Report shows no formal actions and zero occurrences of "cyanide" (verified 3–0). Caution: ICIS processes DMR noncompliance quarterly; this may change at the next refresh.
- **Superfund profiles:** Kysor — six commingled VOC plumes, no cyanide; Northernnaire — announcements state EPA is working **with the Cadillac LDFA** to sample monitoring wells beginning fall 2025 for **VOCs, hexavalent chromium, and PFAS only**. Silence on cyanide in current pages does not erase the documented historical cyanide wastes (all verified 3–0).
- One initially extracted claim — that the Northernnaire profile identifies chromium as the *predominant* contaminant with *no* cyanide mention anywhere — was **refuted 1–2** on verification and is excluded.

4.3 Cadillac LDFA

- Verified role: formed in the 1990s; financed and operates the groundwater extraction/treatment system (operational Aug 1996; carbon adsorption + air stripping) discharging to the Clam River under NPDES limits (EPA Five-Year Review, semspub.epa.gov/work/HQ/178184.pdf).
- The city's LDFA webpage names no contaminant and has zero hits for "cyanide," "violation," or "discharge" (verified 3–0).
- **No evidence ties LDFA pumps, lift stations, or pipelines to any cyanide release.** LDFA meeting minutes, contracts, and engineering documents are not posted online in any indexed form — FOIA target.

4.4 City of Cadillac

- **April 20, 2026 City Council minutes** (one day after the flood; the month of the cyanide spike): full 229-line PDF extracted; **zero** matches for cyanide, pretreatment, IPP, EGLE, or enforcement. Environmental discussion = PFAS grant status; sewer discussion = flood damage and capital planning (verified 3–0).
- **2023 IPP significant-noncompliance notice** (via Cadillac News, Feb 2024): "Factories in Cadillac discharged more cyanide, zinc, copper, silver, cadmium and molybdenum into the city's sewer system than they were permitted to in 2023"; "Five of seven factories listed in the notice tested in exceedance all four quarters of the year." Utilities director Jeffrey Dietlin: "there was no known environmental impact to the Clam River or the Muskegon River watershed as a result"; no pass-through events in 2023. The

underlying city notice (which names the facilities) was not directly obtainable — FOIA target.

4.5 Workplace Safety (OSHA / MIOSHA)

- **No OSHA/MIOSHA inspection, citation, complaint, or exposure record involving cyanide in Cadillac surfaced** in any searched source for the review window.
 - Access limitation: OSHA's IMIS establishment search requires interactive form submission and could not be executed by automated fetch (attempted 07/18/2026; only the search form was returned). MIOSHA records are similarly not indexed for direct search. **Absence of evidence here is weak** — a manual IMIS query and a MIOSHA FOIA are the reliable routes.
 - No verified claim documents any employee exposure to cyanide in Cadillac in 2026.
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5. Source-by-Source Analysis

Primary — federal data (highest weight)

1. [EPA ECHO Effluent Charts, MI0020257](#) and [DMR CSV download](#) — the core evidence. Machine-readable official DMR data; independently re-downloaded and reproduced. Supports findings on the exceedance, the missing violation flag, the NOV's, and the monthly time series.
2. [EPA Detailed Facility Report, MI0020257](#) — confirms no formal enforcement, no cyanide-labeled actions.
3. [EPA Superfund profile — Northernair Plating](#) — current site status; fall 2025 LDFA well-sampling plan (no cyanide analyte).
4. [EPA Superfund profile — Kysor Industrial Corp](#) — six VOC plumes; no cyanide.
5. [EPA Five-Year Review \(semspub 178184\)](#) — LDFA role and treatment-plant operation.

Primary — federal court records

6. [Kelley v. Kysor, 826 F. Supp. 1089](#) — sewer "designed to allow exfiltration of contaminant-laden wastewater into the ground." (Note: this opinion's removal-action quantities — "5,402 gallons of cyanide wastes, and 160 drums" — appeared in one extracted claim that failed verification 0–3 on attribution details; treat specific quantities with caution.)
7. [US v. Meyer, 120 F. Supp. 2d 635](#) — leaking joints; MDEQ elevated cyanide in soil.

Primary — state/local

8. [EGLE IPP program page](#) — framework only.
9. [EGLE Cadillac Industrial Park AOI](#) — PFAS/chromium; no cyanide.

10. [Cadillac City Council minutes, 4/20/2026](#) — silent on cyanide/IPP.
11. [City LDFA page](#) — generic; no contaminant named.
12. [City water/wastewater fact sheet](#) — plant background.

Secondary — news (corroborated where possible)

13. [Cadillac News, Feb 2024 — factories exceeded limits in 2023](#) — only source directly confirming cyanide IPP exceedances; reports the city's official SNC notice.
14. [9&10 News, Jul 14, 2026 — EGLE violation for unreported spill](#)
15. [UpNorthLive — state probe of Cadillac WWTP](#) — EGLE quote on reporting-only violations.
16. [Cadillac News — EGLE: no detectable Clam River impact](#)
17. [Detroit News, Apr 19, 2026 — flood disables lift station](#)
18. [Cadillac News — "What was Northern Plating Co.?"](#) — 1981 abandonment details.

Full-text checks of every 2026 flood/spill article found **zero mentions of cyanide** — the April DMR spike has received no press coverage found to date.

6. Conflicting Evidence, Gaps & Unresolved Questions

Conflicts

- The face-value DMR exceedance (125 vs 5.9 µg/L, Enforcement-type limit) vs. ECHO's "No Violation Identified." Most plausible reconciliation: quarterly ICIS RNC processing lag. This is an inference; the alternative (a substantive determination, e.g., an approved upset/bypass defense) cannot be excluded from public data.
- City officials' 2023 statement of "no pass-through" vs. the April 2026 effluent spike, which by definition is pollution leaving the plant. These concern different years and are not strictly contradictory, but the 2026 event undercuts any assumption that the WWTP always intercepts cyanide slugs.
- Current EPA/EGLE industrial-park monitoring omits cyanide even though historical cyanide contamination at Northern Plating is court-documented.

Refuted claims (excluded from findings)

1. "Northern Plating profile identifies chromium, not cyanide, with no cyanide mention" — refuted 1–2.
2. "1982 removal took thousands of gallons + 160 drums of cyanide wastes" — refuted 0–3 (attribution/date details did not hold).
3. "Michigan's IPP operates as a component of the federal NPDES system, so IPP violations are traceable in ECHO" — refuted 0–3 (IPP violations by industrial users are

generally *not* visible in ECHO — which is itself why the 2023 exceedances don't appear there).

Key open questions

1. **Who caused the April 2026 spike?** No influent data, IPP monitoring data, or industrial-user self-monitoring for Mar–May 2026 is public.
2. **What do the two NOVs (5/22, 6/10/2026) actually cite** — the cyanide DMR, the flood reporting failure, or both?
3. **Which seven factories** were in the 2023 SNC notice, and what were their cyanide values, limits, and follow-up enforcement?
4. **Was the flood causally linked to the cyanide exceedance** (e.g., washout of a pretreatment system, or bypass of cyanide-relevant treatment), and did EGLE's Clam River assessment include cyanide analysis?
5. Was June 2026 clean? (DMR not yet posted.)

Records searched but unavailable / access-limited: MiEnviro Portal documents (JS-only interface); Cadillac IPP local records; LDFA minutes/contracts/engineering documents; Wexford County records (no indexed environmental records found); OSHA IMIS results (form-only interface) and MIOSHA records; WWTP influent data; the EGLE violation notice text; the city's 2023 SNC notice itself. Search-term variants used included: "Cadillac Michigan cyanide," "Cadillac MI cyanide discharge," "Cadillac wastewater cyanide," "Cadillac IPP violation," "Cadillac industrial pretreatment cyanide," "Cadillac LDFA cyanide," "Cadillac LDFA pumps," "MiEnviro Cadillac cyanide," "EGLE Cadillac cyanide," "EPA ECHO Cadillac Michigan," "Wexford County cyanide," "cyanide employee exposure Cadillac," plus NPDES permit-number and Superfund-site variants across all five search angles.

7. Records to Request via FOIA

From EGLE (Michigan FOIA):

1. The violation notice(s) issued to the City of Cadillac in 2026, including the May 22 and June 10, 2026 notices logged in ICIS (MI-65728194750515318; MI-13706853456066754), with all attachments.
2. All correspondence between EGLE and the City of Cadillac, Jan 1–Jul 18, 2026, regarding cyanide, DMR results, the April flood discharge, or NPDES MI0020257 compliance.
3. Cadillac WWTP DMRs and any noncompliance notifications (24-hour/5-day reports) for Mar–Jun 2026.
4. EGLE's Clam River post-spill sampling data and lab reports (Apr–Jul 2026), including analyte lists.

5. Cadillac IPP program audit files, annual IPP reports (2023–2026), and any EGLE review of Cadillac's significant-noncompliance determinations.

From EPA Region 5 (federal FOIA):

1. ICIS-NPDES compliance-determination records for MI0020257, Q2 2026, including any RNC/SNC determinations and QNCR entries.
2. Any communications between EPA R5 and EGLE or the City of Cadillac re: MI0020257 cyanide, Jan–Jul 2026.
3. Northernaire/Kysor fall-2025 monitoring-well sampling results and the analyte selection rationale (why cyanide was excluded).

From City of Cadillac (Michigan FOIA):

1. The complete 2023 (and 2024–2025 if issued) annual significant-noncompliance publication, including the names of all seven facilities and quarterly monitoring data.
2. All IPP industrial-user self-monitoring reports, city sampling of industrial users, and WWTP influent/headworks cyanide data, Jan 2023–Jul 2026.
3. IPP permits, violation notices, compliance schedules, and enforcement correspondence for all significant industrial users, 2023–2026.
4. WWTP operating logs, bench sheets, and lab reports for cyanide, Mar–Jun 2026, plus any upset/bypass claims submitted.
5. All records regarding the April 18–19, 2026 lift-station failure and the response to EGLE's violation notice.

From Cadillac LDFA (Michigan FOIA):

1. Meeting minutes and packets, Jan 2025–Jul 2026.
2. Contracts, engineering reports, and O&M records for the groundwater treatment plant, extraction wells, pumps, and pipelines, 2024–2026.
3. Monitoring-well and treatment-plant effluent lab data (all analytes), 2024–2026, and correspondence with EPA/EGLE about the fall-2025 sampling.

8. Draft FOIA Requests

8.1 To EGLE (FOIA Coordinator, Michigan Dept. of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy — submit via EGLE FOIA portal or FOIA-EGLE@michigan.gov)

Pursuant to Michigan's Freedom of Information Act, MCL 15.231 et seq., I request copies of the following records concerning the City of Cadillac wastewater treatment

plant, NPDES Permit No. MI0020257, and the City of Cadillac Industrial Pretreatment Program, for January 1, 2026 through the date this request is processed unless otherwise stated: (1) All violation notices, notices of noncompliance, or enforcement notices issued to the City of Cadillac in 2026, including those recorded in EPA's ICIS system under identifiers MI-65728194750515318 (dated May 22, 2026) and MI-13706853456066754 (dated June 10, 2026), with all attachments and enclosures; (2) All correspondence (letters and emails) between EGLE and the City of Cadillac concerning cyanide, discharge monitoring report results, or the April 2026 flood-related discharge; (3) All discharge monitoring reports, and all 24-hour and 5-day noncompliance notifications, submitted for Permit MI0020257 for monitoring periods March through June 2026; (4) All surface-water sampling data, laboratory reports, and analyte lists from EGLE's assessment of the Clam River following the April 2026 discharge; (5) The most recent EGLE audit or program review of the City of Cadillac's Industrial Pretreatment Program, and the city's annual IPP reports for 2023 through 2026. I request that records be provided electronically. If any portion is exempt, please release all reasonably segregable non-exempt portions and cite the specific exemption for each redaction. As this request concerns public health and environmental compliance and the information will contribute to public understanding, I request a fee waiver; if the waiver is denied, please inform me before incurring costs above \$25.

8.2 To EPA Region 5 (submit via FOIAonline / foia.gov to EPA Region 5, Chicago)

Pursuant to the Freedom of Information Act, 5 U.S.C. § 552, I request the following records concerning NPDES Permit MI0020257 (City of Cadillac WWTP, Cadillac, Michigan): (1) All compliance-determination records, reportable/significant noncompliance (RNC/SNC) determinations, and Quarterly Noncompliance Report entries for the second quarter of calendar year 2026, including any records explaining the violation-severity coding of the April 2026 cyanide DMR values (DMR event ID 3628288631); (2) All correspondence between EPA Region 5 and either EGLE or the City of Cadillac from January 1, 2026 to the date of processing concerning cyanide discharges or DMR exceedances at this facility; (3) For the Northern Plating Superfund site (EPA ID MID065975844, Site ID 0502440) and Kysor Industrial Corp site: the fall 2025 monitoring-well sampling results conducted with the Cadillac Local Development Finance Authority, and records documenting the selection of analytes (VOCs, hexavalent chromium, PFAS) including any evaluation of whether cyanide should be sampled. I request electronic delivery, itemized justification for any redactions, and a fee waiver as disclosure will contribute significantly to public understanding of government environmental-compliance operations; if fees will exceed \$25, please contact me first.

8.3 To City of Cadillac (FOIA Coordinator, 200 N. Lake St., Cadillac, MI 49601)

Pursuant to Michigan's Freedom of Information Act, MCL 15.231 et seq., I request the following records of the City of Cadillac and its wastewater utility: (1) The city's annual publication(s) of industrial users in significant noncompliance with Industrial Pretreatment Program requirements (per 40 CFR 403.8(f)(2)(viii)) for calendar years 2023, 2024, and 2025, including the identities of all listed facilities; (2) All industrial-user self-monitoring reports and all city-collected sampling results for cyanide from any industrial user, sewer location, or treatment-plant influent/headworks, January 1, 2023 through the date of processing; (3) All IPP permits, violation notices, compliance schedules, administrative orders, and enforcement correspondence issued to any significant industrial user, 2023 to present; (4) Wastewater treatment plant laboratory bench sheets, operating logs, and third-party laboratory reports for cyanide analyses, March 1 through June 30, 2026, together with any upset, bypass, or affirmative-defense documentation submitted in connection with April 2026 effluent results under NPDES Permit MI0020257; (5) All records concerning the April 18–19, 2026 lift-station failure, the discharge to the Clam River, and the city's response to EGLE's 2026 violation notice(s). Please provide records electronically, release segregable portions of any partially exempt records with exemptions cited, and contact me before incurring fees above \$25. I request a public-interest fee waiver.

8.4 To Cadillac Local Development Finance Authority (c/o City of Cadillac FOIA Coordinator)

Pursuant to Michigan's Freedom of Information Act, MCL 15.231 et seq., I request the following records of the Cadillac Local Development Finance Authority (LDFA): (1) Minutes, agendas, and meeting packets of the LDFA board, January 1, 2025 through the date of processing; (2) All contracts, engineering reports, inspection reports, and operation-and-maintenance records concerning the LDFA groundwater treatment plant, extraction wells, pumps, lift stations, and associated pipelines, January 1, 2024 to present; (3) All laboratory analytical results (all analytes, including but not limited to cyanide, hexavalent chromium, VOCs, and PFAS) for monitoring wells, treatment-plant influent, and treatment-plant effluent, January 1, 2024 to present; (4) All correspondence with EPA or EGLE concerning site monitoring or sampling at the Northernair Plating or Kysor Industrial Corp Superfund sites, including the sampling program that began in fall 2025. Please provide records electronically, cite exemptions for any redactions, and contact me before incurring fees above \$25.

Appendix: Method & Verification Statistics

Five parallel search angles (EGLE/MiEnviro; EPA ECHO/enforcement; industrial dischargers & legacy contamination; City/LDFA records; news/complaints/workplace exposure) generated 30 candidate sources; after relevance filtering and URL dedup, 16 were fetched in full and 78 falsifiable claims extracted. The top 25 claims each received three independent adversarial verification votes (verifiers instructed to refute, with independent re-download of primary data where possible): 22 confirmed, 3 refuted, 0 unverified; refuted claims are disclosed in Section 6 and excluded from all findings. Confidence labels: **high** = primary source independently reproduced or 3–0 verification on primary records; **medium** = secondary source, single-source, or absence-of-evidence inference. Post-workflow spot-checks (07/18/2026): OSHA IMIS establishment search (form-only interface; no automated results) and MiEnviro portal (JS application; 404 on direct fetch) — both documented as access limitations.